- Tirrihannah Tea Estate, about 35 km from Siliguri, employs 1,200 permanent and 1,300 casual workers. In December, the management suspended operations because of non-availability of cash to pay wages. 'Tirrihannah has not made a single payment since the note ban announcement on November 8,' said Gautam Ghosh, general secretary of the union. 'There was no agitation and workers did not prevent the dispatch of tea (produced in the gardens). The management has used the cash crisis as an excuse to shut down the garden.'[24]
- After finding himself reeling under mounting debts and no liquidity, Achyut Bhuyan, a worker of Pipratoli Tea Estate at Chabua in Dibrugarh district of eastern Assam, committed suicide last week. He consumed poison because of his mounting debts. The worker was plunged into a debt trap because of irregular payments by his employer on account of the cash crunch precipitated by demonetization.[25]
- According to the Association of Planters in Kerala, the plantation sector in south India has been going through a crisis. 'The situation became worse owing to the ill effects of demonetization. Most migrant workers left plantations as they did not get wages on time.'[26]

Tourism and Those Dependent On It

The winter months are peak months for tourism in India. As a result of demonetization, both foreign and local tourists got stranded without cash, resulting in losses across the tourism chain. Small guest houses and hotels, transport operators, tourist guides, right down to sellers of trinkets – everyone lost an entire season.

The stories below were from Rishikesh, but were reflective of the situation at every tourist destination in the country at the time.